

`Abbas: Abu Bakr went out while `Umar bin Al-Khattab was talking to the people. Abu Bakr said, "Sit down, O `Umar!" But `Umar refused to sit down. So the people came to Abu Bakr and left `Umar. Abu Bakr said, "To proceed, if anyone amongst you used to worship Muhammad, then Muhammad is dead, but if (anyone of) you used to worship Allah, then Allah is Alive and shall never die. Allah said:--"Muhammad is no more than an Apostle, and indeed (many) apostles have passed away before him..(till the end of the Verse).....Allah will reward to those who are thankful." (3.144) By Allah, it was as if the people never knew that Allah had revealed this Verse before till Abu Bakr recited it and all the people received it from him, and I heard everybody reciting it (then). Narrated Az-Zuhri: Sa`id bin Al-Musaiyab told me that `Umar said, "By Allah, when I heard Abu Bakr reciting it, my legs could not support me and I fell down at the very moment of hearing him reciting it, declaring that the Prophet (ﷺ) had died."
(Bukhari: 4452-54)

Indicators of Abu Bakr's Caliphate:

1. There are two major opinions within the Sunni Muslims:
 - a. The Prophet ﷺ explicitly indicated towards the caliphate of Abu Bakr.
 - b. The Prophet ﷺ implicitly indicated towards the caliphate of Abu Bakr (majority opinion).
2. The majority opinion quotes the following narrations:
 - a. Narrated Jubair bin Mut`im:

A woman came to the Prophet (ﷺ) who ordered her to return to him again. She said, "What if I came and did not find you?" as if she wanted to say, "If I found you dead?" The Prophet (ﷺ) said, "If you should not find me, go to Abu Bakr."
(Bukhari: 3659)
 - b. Narrated Ibn `Umar:

Allah's Messenger (ﷺ) said, "(I saw in a dream that) while I was standing at a well and drawing water therefrom, suddenly Abu Bakr and `Umar came to me. Abu Bakr took the bucket and drew one or two buckets (full of water), but there was weakness in his pulling, but Allah forgave him. Then Ibn Al- Khattab took the bucket from Abu Bakr's hand and the bucket turned into a very large one in his hand. I have never seen any strong man among the people doing such a hard job as `Umar did, till (the people drank to their satisfaction) and water their camels to their fill and they sat near the water."
(Bukhari: 7019)
 - c. A'isha reported that Allah's Messenger (ﷺ) in his (last) illness asked me to call Abu Bakr, her father, and her brother too, so that he might write a document, for he feared that someone else might be desirous (of succeeding him) and that some claimant may say:

I have better claim to it, whereas Allah and the Faithful do not substantiate the claim of anyone but that of Abu Bakr.

(Muslim: 2387)

d. When the Prophet ﷺ fell ill, he said,

"Order Abu Bakr to lead the people in prayer."

(Bukhari: 3385)

Pledge of Allegiance in Banu Sa'idah

1. We find this hadith in **Bukhari (6830)** regarding the pledge of allegiance of Abu Bakr:

*And no doubt after the death of the Prophet (ﷺ) we were informed that the Ansar disagreed with us and gathered in the shed of Bani Sa'da. `Ali and Zubair and whoever was with them, opposed us, while the emigrants gathered with Abu Bakr. I said to Abu Bakr, **'Let's go to these Ansari brothers of ours.'** So we set out seeking them, and when we approached them, two pious men of theirs met us and informed us of the final decision of the Ansar, and said, **'O group of Muhajirin (emigrants) ! Where are you going?'** We replied, **'We are going to these Ansari brothers of ours.'** They said to us, **'You shouldn't go near them. Carry out whatever we have already decided.'** I said, **'By Allah, we will go to them.'** And so we proceeded until we reached them at the shed of Bani Sa'da. Behold! There was a man sitting amongst them and wrapped in something. I asked, 'Who is that man?' They said, **'He is Sa'd bin 'Ubada.'** I asked, **'What is wrong with him?'** They said, **'He is sick.'** After we sat for a while, the Ansar's speaker said, **'None has the right to be worshipped but Allah,'** and praising Allah as He deserved, he added, **'To proceed, we are Allah's Ansar (helpers) and the majority of the Muslim army, while you, the emigrants, are a small group and some people among you came with the intention of preventing us from practicing this matter (of caliphate) and depriving us of it.'** When the speaker had finished, I intended to speak as I had prepared a speech which I liked and which I wanted to deliver in the presence of Abu Bakr, and I used to avoid provoking him. So, when I wanted to speak, Abu Bakr said, **'Wait a while.'** I disliked to make him angry. So Abu Bakr himself gave a speech, and he was wiser and more patient than I. By Allah, he never missed a sentence that I liked in my own prepared speech, but he said the like of it or better than it spontaneously. After a pause he said, **'O Ansar! You deserve all (the qualities that you have attributed to yourselves, but this question (of Caliphate) is only for the Quraish as they are the best of the Arabs as regards descent and home, and I am pleased to suggest that you choose either of these two men, so take the oath of allegiance to either of them as you wish.'** And then Abu Bakr held my hand and Abu Ubaida bin al-Jarrah's hand who was sitting amongst us. I hated nothing of what he had said except that proposal, for by Allah, I would rather have my neck chopped off as expiator for a sin than become the ruler of a nation, one of whose members is Abu Bakr, unless at the time of my death my own-self suggests something I don't feel at present.' And then one of the Ansar said, **'I am the pillar on which the camel with a skin disease (eczema) rubs itself to satisfy the itching (i.e., I am a noble), and I am as a high class palm tree! O Quraish. There should be one ruler from us and one from you.'** Then there was a hue and cry among the gathering and their voices rose so that I was afraid there might be great disagreement, so I said, **'O Abu Bakr! Hold your hand out.'** He held his hand*

out and I pledged allegiance to him, and then all the emigrants gave the Pledge of allegiance and so did the Ansar afterwards. And so we became victorious over Sa'd bin Ubada (whom Al-Ansar wanted to make a ruler). One of the Ansar said, 'You have killed Sa'd bin Ubada.' I replied, 'Allah has killed Sa'd bin Ubada.' Umar added, "By Allah, apart from the great tragedy that had happened to us (i.e. the death of the Prophet), there was no greater problem than the allegiance pledged to Abu Bakr because we were afraid that if we left the people, they might give the Pledge of allegiance after us to one of their men, in which case we would have given them our consent for something against our real wish, or would have opposed them and caused great trouble. So if any person gives the Pledge of allegiance to somebody (to become a Caliph) without consulting the other Muslims, then the one he has selected should not be granted allegiance, lest both of them should be killed."

2. Also, in the narration of Musnad Ahmad, it is mentioned that Abu Bakr said:

When the Messenger of Allah ﷺ died, Abu Bakr was in some other area of Madinah. He came and uncovered his face and kissed him, and said: May my father and mother be sacrificed for you; how good you look in life and in death. Muhammad ﷺ has died, by the Lord of the Ka'bah... Then Abu Bakr and Umar came together to the people, Abu Bakr spoke and did not omit anything that was revealed concerning the Ansar or that the Messenger of Allah ﷺ had said concerning them but he mentioned it. And he said: You know that the Messenger of Allah ﷺ said: 'If the people were to walk in one direction and the Ansar were to walk in another, I would walk in the direction of the Ansar.' I know, O Sa'd, that the Messenger of Allah ﷺ said, when you were sitting here: 'Quraish are to be in charge of this affair (Islam), so the righteous people are but followers of the righteous of (Quraish), and the wrongdoers among the people are but followers of the wrongdoers of (Quraish).' Sa'd said to him: You have spoken the truth: we are advisers and you are leaders.

(Musnad Ahmad: 18)

3. Abu Bakr also cited two verses of Qur'an, 59:8-9 & 9:119, proving that Allah has ordered to be with or to follow the Muhajiroon. There was wisdom behind appointing Quraish as the leaders:

- a. The leader should have been the one behind whom all Arabs could unite.
- b. As the Quraish were the custodians of Ka'bah, people honored them because of that.
- c. Over a past few decades, the Quraish had a superior status among all Arabs.
- d. Allah sent the last Prophet ﷺ from them.

4. In another narration Umar reminded Ansar by saying,

It was narrated that 'Abdullah said:

"When the Messenger of Allah (ﷺ) passed away, the Ansar said: 'Let there be an Amir from among us and an Amir from among you.' Then Umar came to them and said: 'Do you not know that the Messenger of Allah (ﷺ) commanded Abu Bakr to lead the people in prayer? Who among you could accept to put himself ahead of Abu Bakr?' They said: 'We seek refuge with Allah from putting ourselves ahead of Abu Bakr.'"

Lessons:

1. A Muslim should win **hearts of people who disagree** with him but **praising** his good qualities and presenting clear and **logical arguments** that can help convince him.
2. Those who **aspire for positions of leadership** are least deserving of it as it is usually for personal gain, prestige or power at a time when they know there are other people who are capable of such responsibilities.
3. If there would have been **conspiracies by Abu Bakr, Umar and Abu Ubaidah**, Abu Bakr would have then benefitted himself, Umar and Abu Ubaidah in his caliphate and he wouldn't have shown sincerity towards the ummah. However, when we look at his caliphate, we see it is clearly evident that he worked hard to unite the Ummah. Also, if these people would have been greedy, they would have never supported the Prophet ﷺ in Makkah in the first place which was the toughest time the Muslim ummah had to face initially and it was the time that the Muslims had to lose much not at this point where the ummah was extremely stable and expanding.

General Pledge of Allegiance:

1. Narrated Anas bin Malik:

That he heard `Umar's second speech he delivered when he sat on the pulpit on the day following the death of the Prophet (ﷺ) `Umar recited the Tashahhud while Abu Bakr was silent. `Umar said, "I wish that Allah's Messenger (ﷺ) had outlived all of us, i.e., had been the last (to die). But if Muhammad is dead, Allah nevertheless has kept the light amongst you from which you can receive the same guidance as Allah guided Muhammad with that. And Abu Bakr is the companion of Allah's Messenger (ﷺ) He is the second of the two in the cave. He is the most entitled person among the Muslims to manage your affairs. Therefore get up and swear allegiance to him." Some people had already taken the oath of allegiance to him in the shed of Bani Sa`ida but the oath of allegiance taken by the public was taken at the pulpit. I heard `Umar saying to Abu Bakr on that day. "Please ascend the pulpit," and kept on urging him till he ascended the pulpit whereupon, all the people swore allegiance to him.

(Bukhari: 7219)

2. Abu Bakr stood up and addressed the Muslims with a powerful yet humble speech:
"O People! I have been appointed over you, but I am not the best among you. If I do well, then help me; and if I do wrong, then set me right. Truth is honesty, and falsehood is treachery. The weak among you is strong with me until I secure his rights for him, if Allah wills. And the strong among you is weak with me until I take the rights of others from him, if Allah wills. No people abandon Jihad in the path of Allah but that Allah humiliates them. And evil will never spread in a people except that Allah envelops them with tribulation. Obey me so long as I obey Allah and His Messenger. But if I disobey Allah and His Messenger, then you owe me no obedience. Arise for your prayer, may Allah have mercy on you."